A-A-54248
19 September 1990

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SUTURE REMOVAL KIT (Disposable)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-S-36957A which is cancelled

This commercial item description covers sterile suture removal kits suitable for use in cutting and removal of sutures

Salient characteristics:

General. The suture removal kits shall be furnished in either Type I, Type II or Type III as specified and described herein

Material Gauze pad shall be two-ply with a suitable filler Forceps and scissors shall be stainless steel or have nickel plated carbon steel. Nickel plated instruments shall have a minimum plating thickness of 0.0002 inch for Type I and Type II and 0 0001 inch for Type III Type I and Type II forceps and scissors handles (Type II only) may be plastic

Style, design and dimensions The kit shall be a sterile disposable suture removal kit suitable for cutting and removal of sutures The suture removal kit shall consist of the following components:

Type	Components
I & II	Scissors, forceps and gauze pad.
III	Scissors, forceps and inner wrapper

Type I, II, and III kit design shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing No 24145 and as described herein

AMSC N/A FSC 6515
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Forceps shall have precisely meeting tips suitable for the gripping and removal of sutures. Forceps shall withstand use with povidine, peroxide and isopropyl alcohol solutions Type I suture removal kit shall consist of a 4 inch by 3 inch gauze pad, forceps and scissors with non-corroding blades The disposable scissors shall be capable of cutting chromic size 1, plain size 0, Silk size 0, wire size 4-0 and nylon size 5-0 sutures The scissors shall be approximately 4- 3/4 inches in length and shall have non-corroding blades of the LITTAUER style The components shall be securely positioned in a rigid tray with a peel-open cover

Type II suture removal kit shall consist of 4 inch by 4 inch gauze pad, metal or plastic forceps and metal scissors overwrapped in a paper towel sheet or securely positioned in a ridig tray with a peel-open cover The scissors shall be approximately 4-1/2 inches long and have one scalloped or sharp point (as shown on drawing) and one blunt point

Type III suture removal kit shall consist of scissors, forceps and an inner wrapper The scissors shall be of the LITTAUER style and shall be capable of cutting any of gut or thread suture material The inner wrapper shall not be smaller than 9 inches x 8-1/4 inches and shall be moisture repellant on one side and absorbant on the other side The kit shall be prepackaged

Workmanship The suture removal kit shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability Plated components shall be free from surface or embedded debris Finish shall be smooth and even with no discolorations, stains or blemishes Components shall have a smooth finish and be free from rough edges, slivers, nicks, pits, blisters, scratches, cracks, contamination, metal particles and foreign material

Plating thickness Plating thickness shall be either +/- 10 percent of specified value when subjected to the Kocour tests

Sterility The suture removal kit inner surfaces and components shall be sterile in accordance with USP or AAMI guidelines The kit shall have a sterility assurance level of 0 000001

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Scissors performance. On the first closing of the blades, the scissors shall be capable of cutting the following sutures:

Type I scissors. Chromic size 1, plain size 0, silk size 0, wire size 4-0, and nylon size 5-0.

Type II scissors. Plain gut sizes down to size 0, chromic gut sizes down to size 1, braided silk sizes down to size 0 and nylon down to size 0.

Type III scissors. Any type of gut or thread material.

The strand of suture to be cut with the scissors shall be held at one end, with thumb and forefinger, in a vertical position. Tension shall be applied to the suture by securing a 25.0 gram weight to other end.

Scissors shall be perpendicular to suture when in a cutting position. Suture to be cut shall be placed on blade approximately 1/8 inch from point of blade. The scissors and tip of the scissors shall remain aligned after cuts. Each scissors tested shall cut three times and a different scissors shall be used to cut each type, and size of suture specified above.

Forceps pull test. The forceps will be subjected to the following pull tests. The forceps shall not slip or break the suture at the forceps with a pull load of 250 grams.

Attach a short section of 3-0 silk suture to a dial indicator spring scale and zero the scale. Each forcep must satisfactorily pass this test in each of the 3 directions listed below, ie, 90, 135 and 180 degrees.

1. With forceps at a 90 degree angle from the vertical suture, grasp the suture with the tip area of the forcep, then apply a steady downward force. Record the highest reading just before the forceps starts to slip.

2. With forceps at a 135 degree angle (with tips pointing up) grasp the suture with the tip area of the forceps and apply a steady downward force. Record the dial indicator highest reading just before the forceps starts to slip.

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3 With the forceps in a 180 degree line with the suture (tips pointing up toward upper end of suture) grasp the suture with the tip area of the forceps and apply a steady downward force record the highest reading shown on the dial indicator just before the forceps start to slip

Unit Package (PG) Each suture removal kit shall be individually packaged in a sealed peel-open type container capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless package is damaged or opened One package containing 48 individually packaged suture removal kits (Type I), 50 individually packaged suture removal kits (Type II), or 50 individually packaged suture removal kits (Type III) as specified, constitutes one unit

Quality Assurance Provisions

Responsibility for inspection Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements

Records Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as specified herein Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one suture removal kit Sampling shall be Inspection level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.0

Examination Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements

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Sampling for tests Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein Unit of product for test purposes shall be one suture removal kit. Sampling shall be Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL Of 1.0

Tests Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics

Contractor certification The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices The Government reserves the right to require the proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No 376, and all other requirements of this document are met

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product

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Regulatory requirements

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations

Recovered materials The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23 4 to the maximum extent practical

Preservation, packaging, packing labeling and marking Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc , involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations Intermediate and exterior package quantities, labels and markings shall be as specified in the contract and/or order

NOTE The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document·

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION	TYPE
6515-01-130-4921	SUTURE REMOVAL KIT, Disposable, 48s	I
6515-00-436-1881	SUTURE REMOVAL KIT Disposable, 50s	II
6515-00-690-6911	SUTURE REMOVAL KIT (Sterile Disposable)	III

NOTE 2· This CID is also used in preference to VA Specification X-13114G

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Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent

DLA - DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No 6515-4783

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NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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Defense Personnel Support Center
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2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-54248	SUTURE REMOVAL KIT (Disposable)

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last First MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

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